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Article Extraction

The first step in the annotation pipeline is the accurate and complete capture of the source article. This step is a prerequisite for all subsequent annotation tasks and must be carried out before any argumentative or semantic analysis begins. The following rules are binding for all annotators.

Definition of article: An article is a semantic unit that captures a coherent, self-contained discourse on a specific topic or event as published in a single journalistic source.

Extraction Rules:

1. *Completeness:* The article must be captured in its entirety. Text should not be omitted, shortened, or truncated.
2. *Relevance and Scope:* Only relevant articles for the Messina earthiquake should be captured: no adjacent articles, sidebars, captions, advertisements, or any other textual material that does not form part of the article under annotation.
3. *Fidelity to the Original:* The captured text must be identical to the original source. Spelling, punctuation, hyphenation, and paragraph structure must be preserved exactly as published. No corrections, paraphrasing, or reformatting should be done at this stage, even if the original contains apparent errors.
4. *Multiple Articles:* When more than one article is relevant to the extraction task, each article must be captured separately and enclosed in XML markers <article>…</article>.
5. *Absence of a Relevant Article:* If no relevant article can be identified for a given annotation unit, this must be explicitly recorded using the designated placeholder tag "No article found".
6. *Verification and Explanation:* Each captured article is accompanied by four additional structured fields:
    - <verification> a brief quality check confirming whether the unit is coherent, whether the target topic is present, whether the article is complete, and whether all relevant articles have been found.
    - <human_verification_needed> a boolean flag (True/False) indicating whether the extraction requires manual review.
    - <confidence_rate> a numeric score between 0 and 1 reflecting the annotator's or system's confidence in the relevance and completeness of the extracted article.
    - <explain> a short prose justification explaining why the article was deemed relevant to the extraction task.

Example Output:

<article>Verständigung zwischen Picard und Caillaux. (Telegramm der "Neuen Freien Presse".) Paris, 13. März. Der Ausbruch einer Ministerkrise ist ver-hindert worden. Vor dem heutigen Ministerrat fand eine Auseinandersetzung zwischen dem Marineminister Picard, dem Finanzminister Caillaux und dem Ministerpräsidenten Clemenceau statt. Aus dieser Konferenz ist eine Ver-ständigung hervorgegangen, welche durch beiderseitiges Entgegenkommen herbeigeführt wurde. Paris, 13. März. In dem nachmittags im Palais Elysee abgehaltenen Ministerrate teilten die Minister Caillaux und Picard mit, daß sie sich über den Marinevoranschlag auf folgender Grund </article>

<verification>Is unit coherent? Yes. Is topic present? Yes, the topic of the Messina earthquake is mentioned in the context of Kaiser Wilhelm's planned visit to the site of the earthquake. Is article complete? Yes, the article appears to be complete. All articles found? Yes, all relevant articles have been extracted.</verification>

<human_verification_needed>False</human_verification_needed>

<confidence_rate>0.9</confidence_rate>

<explain>The article is relevant because it mentions the Messina earthquake in the context of Kaiser Wilhelm's planned visit to the site of the earthquake. The article provides information on the Kaiser's plans to visit the site of the earthquake, which is a direct consequence of the earthquake. The article also provides context on the political situation in Germany and the plans of the Kaiser, which is relevant to understanding the response to the earthquake.</explain>

Prompt for LLM:

Please follow these specifications:

1. Definition of an article: An article is a semantic unit in the text, clearly distinguished from preceding and following content (for example, may or may not have a title).
2. Relevance criteria: An article is relevant if its main subject is the Messina earthquake of December 1908 or its consequences. Other earthquakes are not relevant. The relevant consequences are mentioned in the system prompt. Make sure to check the publication date.
3. Response format:If one or more relevant articles are found, structure your response using XML tags as shown in the following example, using the tags article, verification and human_verification_needed (True or False): <article>complete content of extracted article 1</article><article>complete content of extracted article 2</article><verification>Is the unit coherent? Is the subject present? Is the article complete? Have all articles been found?</verification><human_verification_needed>False</human_verification_needed>
    - Return all relevant articles in their original form, without additions, omissions, corrections or comments. Never cut content between the beginning and end of an article.

- When several articles (semantic units) are found, split them by using separate xml tags
- If no relevant articles about the Messina earthquake are found (for example, if it concerns another earthquake), no special structuring is needed; simply return "No relevant article found." without further explanation.

4. Notes on segmentation: Ensure that articles form a unit. Be sure to mark each separate unit (marked by a new title or new semantic unit) as a new article <article></article>)
5. Human verification needed:
   - Can have values "True" or "False"
   - False: If you think you have correctly segmented the article and evaluated its relevance.
   - True: If you are unsure whether you have captured the complete content of the article as contained in the newspaper document or if it is relevant.
6. Check verification results and adapt response if necessary

Here is the newspaper document:

Argumentative Unit Extraction

Once the source article has been captured, the annotation proceeds to identify and extract argumentative units. An argumentative unit is a self-contained textual segment that expresses a reasoned position: it contains one or more premises that lead, explicitly or implicitly, to a conclusion.

Definition: An argumentative unit is defined as a textual unit that contains at least one premise and at least one conclusion, where the conclusion may be either explicitly stated in the text or logically implied by the surrounding context. The key criterion is that the text segment, taken together, constitutes a piece of reasoning rather than a bare factual statement.

Extraction Criteria:

All argumentative units must satisfy the following four criteria simultaneously. A segment that fails any single criterion must not be annotated as an argumentative unit.

1. *Structure.* The unit must exhibit a recognisable argument structure, namely one or more premises leading to a conclusion. The conclusion may be implicit, but it must be reconstructable from the text without speculation.

2. *Completeness*: All premises that support a single conclusion must be captured together within the same unit. A unit must not be split across multiple annotations if the premises belong to a single line of reasoning.

3. *Unit Size*: The unit corresponds to a sentence or a paragraph. Sub-sentential fragments are not acceptable unless they independently satisfy the structure and completeness requirements. Conversely, a sequence of multiple paragraphs should only be treated as a single unit if all paragraphs jointly support one conclusion and cannot be separated without losing argumentative coherence

4. *Validity – The Warrant Test*: The unit must pass the warrant test. A warrant is the implicit general principle that connects the premise(s) to the conclusion. If such a principle can be articulated and is plausible in context, the unit is considered valid. If no plausible warrant can be constructed, the segment does not qualify as an argumentative unit.

The Warrant Test in Practice: The warrant test is applied as follows. Given a candidate argumentative unit, the annotator identifies the premise(s) and the conclusion (explicit or implicit). The annotator then asks: what general principle, if accepted, would make the conclusion follow from the premises? If a plausible principle can be stated, the warrant is satisfied.

Example:

> *Premise: "People are suffering and need help."*
>
> *Implicit warrant: If people are suffering and need help, actions need to be taken to provide help.*
>
> *Conclusion: "More action is needed."*

Because the warrant is plausible, this constitutes a valid argumentative unit. If the warrant were implausible or required too much inferential leap, the unit should be excluded.

Boundary Cases: Pure factual statements without any evaluative or normative implication are not argumentative units and must not be annotated as such. Similarly, rhetorical questions that do not lead to a discernible conclusion, and statements that merely describe a situation without implying a response or judgement, fall outside the scope of this annotation task.

Subject-Verb-Object Ontology for Triple Extraction

After argumentative units have been extracted, each unit is mapped to one or more structured knowledge-graph triples. A triple consists of a subject, a predicate, and an object. Triples are grouped into thematic categories that reflect the main argumentative dimensions of the corpus.

Triple Structure

The closest matching triple from the validated ontology is selected. If multiple triples match, all applicable triples are recorded. If a unit cannot be mapped to any existing triple, a new triple is created and added to the ontology. This process continues iteratively until the ontology reaches saturation.

Ontology for Triple Extraction

Category: Aid

Subject	Predicate	Object
aid	insufficient for	damage
aid	insufficient for	recovery
aid	fails to reach	refugees
aid	saved	victims
austria	delivers	aid
damage	limits capacity of	aid
damage	necessitates	aid
military	enables	recovery
society	is obligated to	aid
society	is requested to	aid
society	obligates to	aid
society	lost interest for	aid
aid	reaches	victims
aid	is well organized	organized
aid	did not reach	all cities
international aid	serves	political advantage
international aid	not needed anymore for	recovery
material assistance	more effective than	monetary assistance
aid from germany	enables	recovery
aid from germany	is superior	recovery

Subject	Predicate	Object
aid	necessitates	aid
aid	misused by	italy
germany	delivers	aid

Category: Austria

Subject	Predicate	Object
austria	acts	heroic
austria	effective response to	aid

Category: Crisis

Subject	Predicate	Object
crisis management of italy	not working	crisis

Category: Damage

Subject	Predicate	Object
damage	limits capacity of	aid
damage	prevents	aid
damage	limited impact on	banks
damage	benefits financially	economy
damage	causes long-term harm to	economy
damage	harms economy of	germany
damage	harms economy of	italy
damage	delays	recovery
population density	increases	damage
damage	risks	epidemic
damage	increases costs for	italian government
damage	necessitates	migration
damage	prevents	navigation

Subject	Predicate	Object
damage	hinders	recovery
damage	creates	trauma

Category: Disorder

Subject	Predicate	Object
damage	causes	disorder
society	protests	italian government

Category: Disorganization

Subject	Predicate	Object
disorganization	undermines	aid
disorganization	disproves	italian efficiency
disorganization	harms	italian reputation

Category: Friendship

Subject	Predicate	Object
friendship	obligates to	aid

Category: Italian government

Subject	Predicate	Object
italian government	delays	aid
italian government	effective response to	damage
italian government	maintains	order
italian government	enables	recovery
italian government	insufficient for	recovery
italian government	harms economy of	italy
italian government	can efficiently handle	recovery
italian government	lacks plan for	recovery

Subject	Predicate	Object
italian government	controls	narrative
italian government	spreads	misinformation
italian government	delays	recovery
italian government	must prioritize	recovery
italian government	lacks money for	recovery
italian government	suppresses	media

Category: Journalists

Subject	Predicate	Object
journalists	reveal	disorganization

Category: Military

Subject	Predicate	Object
disorder	justifies	military
military	delays	aid
military	not used enough for	aid
military	enables	recovery
military	harms	victims
military	abuses	aid
military	enables	aid
inaction	delays	aid

Category: Misinformation

Subject	Predicate	Object
military	enables	recovery
italy	spreads	misinformation
italy	fights	misinformation
journalists	spread	misinformation
misinformation	harms	society

Subject	Predicate	Object
italian government	spread	misinformation

Category: Order

Subject	Predicate	Object
italian government	maintains	order
military	maintains	order

Category: Politics

Subject	Predicate	Object
messina	grateful for response	italian government
messina	will achieve	recovery
messina	delays	aid

Category: Recovery

Subject	Predicate	Object
aid	prevents	epidemic
damage	prevents	recovery
economy	enables	recovery
england	strategically supports	recovery
italian government	enables	aid
recovery	hinders	economy
recovery	not	possible
society	responsible for	recovery

Category: Refugees

Subject	Predicate	Object
aid	is requested for	refugees
refugees	necessitates	aid

Subject	Predicate	Object
refugees	enables	recovery
refugees	challenges	stereotype

Category: Royalty

Subject	Predicate	Object
royalty	demands action from	italian government
royalty	supports	aid
royalty	enables	aid
royalty	enables	recovery

Category: Scientific

Subject	Predicate	Object
italian government	must implement	scientific measures
italian government	should implement	scientific measures
scientific	explains	damage
scientific	prevents	damage
scientific	predicts	future
scientific	compares to	past earthquakes
scientific	reveals	human ignorance
society	explains	damage
god	not related to	earthquake

Category: Society

Subject	Predicate	Object
society	is requested to	aid
society	hinders	aid
society	obligates to	aid
society	protests	italian government

Category: Sympathy

Subject	Predicate	Object
damage	evokes	sympathy
sympathy	motivates	aid

Category: Trauma

Subject	Predicate	Object
trauma	undermines	verification
damage	causes	trauma
trauma	undermines	aid

Category: Unity

Subject	Predicate	Object
unity	enables	recovery
unity	enables	aid
unity	supports	crisis